

(By default, “defrag” displays a summary of both the analysis and defragmentation reports if you do not specify the /a or /v parameters.)

/f

Forces defragmentation of the volume when free space is low.

/?

Displays help at the command prompt.

9.1.3 Notes On Using The Command Prompt

You can send the reports to a text file by typing “> FileName.txt”, where “FileName.txt” is a file name you specify. For example:

```
defrag c: /v > report.txt
```

To interrupt the defragmentation process, press [Ctrl] + [C] at the command prompt.

Running the defrag command and Disk Defragmenter—the Windows tool we mentioned above—are mutually exclusive. If you are using Disk Defragmenter to defragment a volume and you run the defrag command at a command prompt, the defrag command fails. Conversely, if you run the defrag command and open Disk Defragmenter, the defragmentation options in Disk Defragmenter are unavailable.

Now here’s a hidden option: if you use “-b” at the command prompt, the defrag utility will optimise the boot files and applications—based on usage information that XP tracks—but it will leave most of the drive untouched. For instance, if you run

```
defrag c: -b
```

at the command prompt, the boot files and some application files will be defragged and possibly moved to a different location on the disk to enable them to be read from disk faster.